

CAT SOCK STUDIO

NIGHTWIRE

Stream Overlay

A complete OBS overlay system — six scenes, live alerts, chat, goals, and a guided customiser. No subscriptions, no cloud account, no image editing.

Setup & Operating Manual

Everything runs on your PC. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.

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Before you start

You need **OBS Studio** and a Windows PC. Everything else is in the folder you were given. The package installs one small helper (Node.js) the first time you run Setup, and nothing else.

Nothing leaves your computer.

The overlay is served by a small program running on your own PC at an address only your PC can reach. There is no account to make, no monthly fee, and no data sent anywhere.

Setting up

Three steps. You do this once.

1 Unzip the folder somewhere permanent.

Your user folder is ideal — for example `C:\Users\YourName\Nightwire`. Do not run it from inside the ZIP, and do not leave it in Downloads where it may be cleaned up.

2 Double-click `Setup.bat`.

It checks for Node.js and installs it if needed, starts the overlay server, sets it to start automatically when you sign in, and opens the dashboard in your browser. Say yes to any Windows permission prompt — that is the Node.js installer.

3 Leave it alone.

From now on the server starts by itself at sign-in. You never need to open a terminal or type a command.

The icon by the clock

Nightwire runs in the background, so there is no window to keep open and nothing to start each day. It puts an icon in the notification area beside the clock, next to the volume and network icons. Windows often hides new icons behind the small $\wedge$ arrow — drag it down onto the taskbar once and it will stay in view.

That icon is the whole control surface:

MENU ITEM	WHAT IT DOES
Open dashboard	The control panel. Double-clicking the icon does the same.
Open setup guide	The short instructions page in this folder.
Restart server	What to use after installing an update.
Stop server and quit	Stops the overlay properly. Your settings are kept.
Leave running and close this menu	Hides the icon but leaves the overlay running.

You should never need Task Manager.

The tray icon owns the overlay it started and stops it by asking it to close, rather than killing it. That is what stops half-stopped copies accumulating and quietly fighting over the address — if you have ever ended a task to fix something, that is the problem it removes.

The other buttons in the folder

All still there if you prefer them, and useful if the icon is ever missing.

FILE	WHAT IT DOES
Setup.bat	First-time install. Safe to run again if something breaks.
Start Server.bat	Starts the overlay and opens the dashboard.
Stop Server.bat	Stops the overlay. Your settings are kept.
Server Status.bat	Whether it is running, and which folder is serving it.
Uninstall.bat	Removes the shortcuts and stops it running at sign-in. Keeps your settings and artwork.

The dashboard address

The dashboard lives at `http://127.0.0.1:8787/dashboard.html`. Bookmark it. That address only works on this PC — that is deliberate, and it is what keeps your controls private.

You can open the dashboard in three places.

A normal browser window on a second monitor; a dock inside OBS (*View → Docks → Custom Browser Docks*); or both at once. They all control the same overlay, because the settings live in the server rather than in any one window.

Adding the overlay to OBS

The fast way takes about a minute and wires up all six scenes for you.

The fast way – import the scene collection

- 1 In OBS, choose *Scene Collection* → *Import*.
- 2 Pick `obs\Nightwire.json` from the package folder.
Every scene, browser source, size and position comes in already set up.
- 3 Switch to the imported collection
under *Scene Collection*.
- 4 Add your camera and game capture.
These are the only two things the import cannot create, because only you know which devices they are. Put both
below
the overlay in the source list, with the
camera above the game capture
— top to bottom that is Overlay, Camera, Game Capture.

Order matters — three layers, in this order top to bottom: Overlay, Camera, Game Capture.

The overlay goes on
top

; the camera opening is a genuine transparent cutout, so the camera shows through it while the frame and nameplate stay drawn over it. The camera itself must sit

above the game capture

, because game capture is a full-screen, opaque source — if it is listed above the camera it will cover the camera completely wherever the two overlap. If you put the camera above the overlay, it will cover the frame instead.

The manual way – one browser source per scene

If you would rather build your own scenes, add a **Browser** source in each one, set it to **1920 × 1080**, and paste the matching address. The **OBS Setup** page in the dashboard has a copy button beside every one of these.

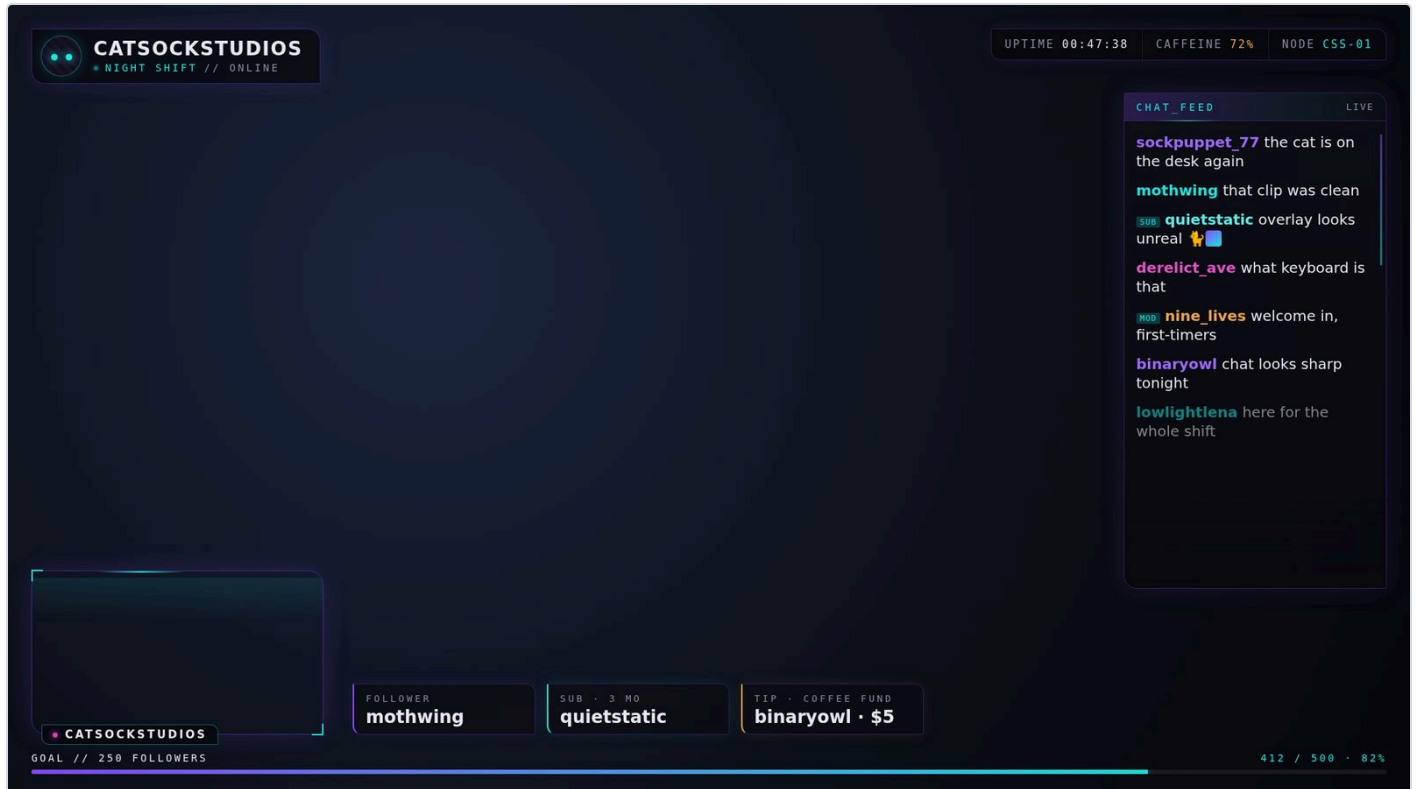
SCENE	ADDRESS
Gameplay	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/gameplay.html</code>
Starting Soon	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/starting-soon.html</code>
Just Chatting	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/just-chatting.html</code>
BRB	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/brb.html</code>
Ending	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/ending.html</code>
Offline	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/offline.html</code>

Browser source settings

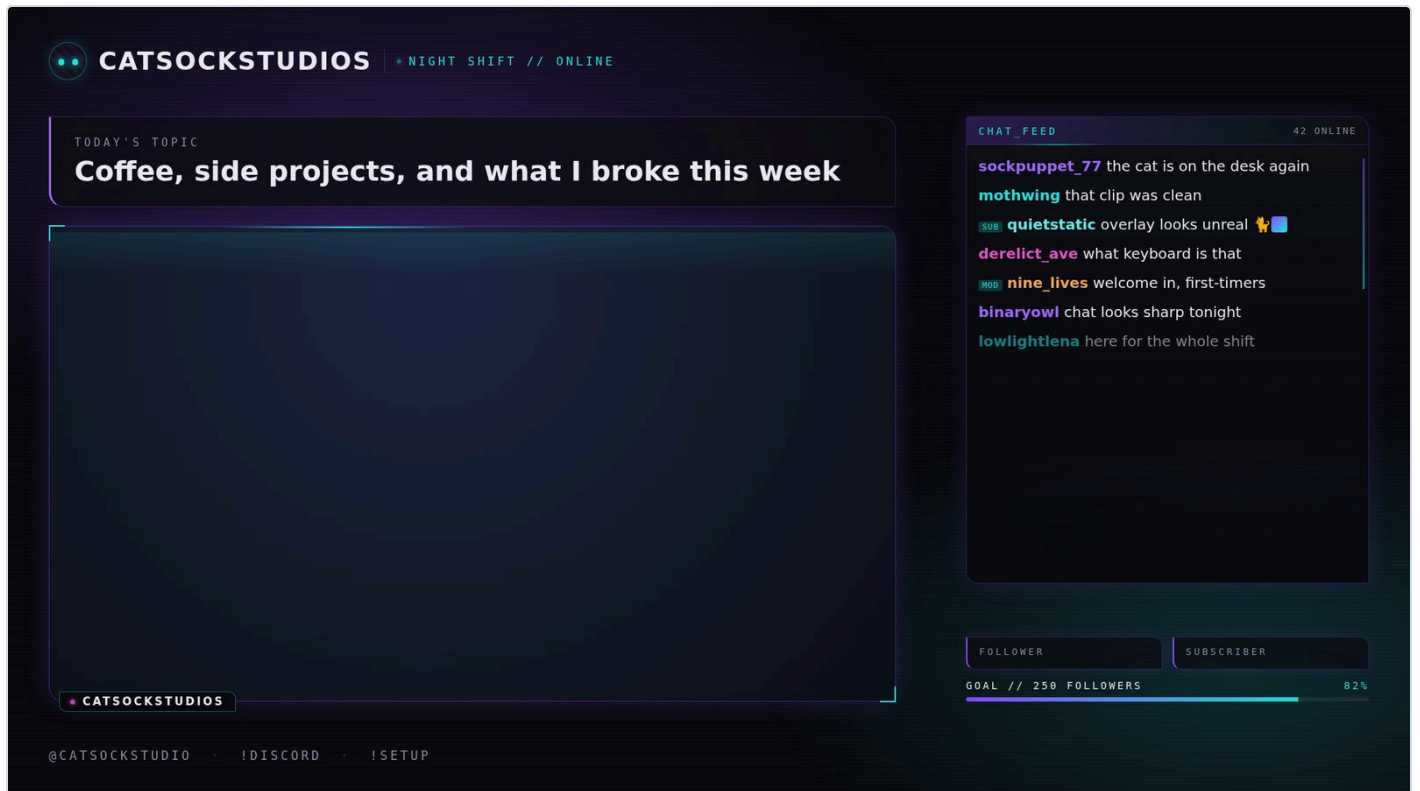
- **Width 1920, Height 1080** for every scene source.
- Leave **Shutdown source when not visible off**, so a scene is ready the moment you cut to it.
- Leave **Refresh browser when scene becomes active off** — changes arrive on their own.
- Do not tick *Control audio via OBS*. The overlay makes no sound.

The six scenes

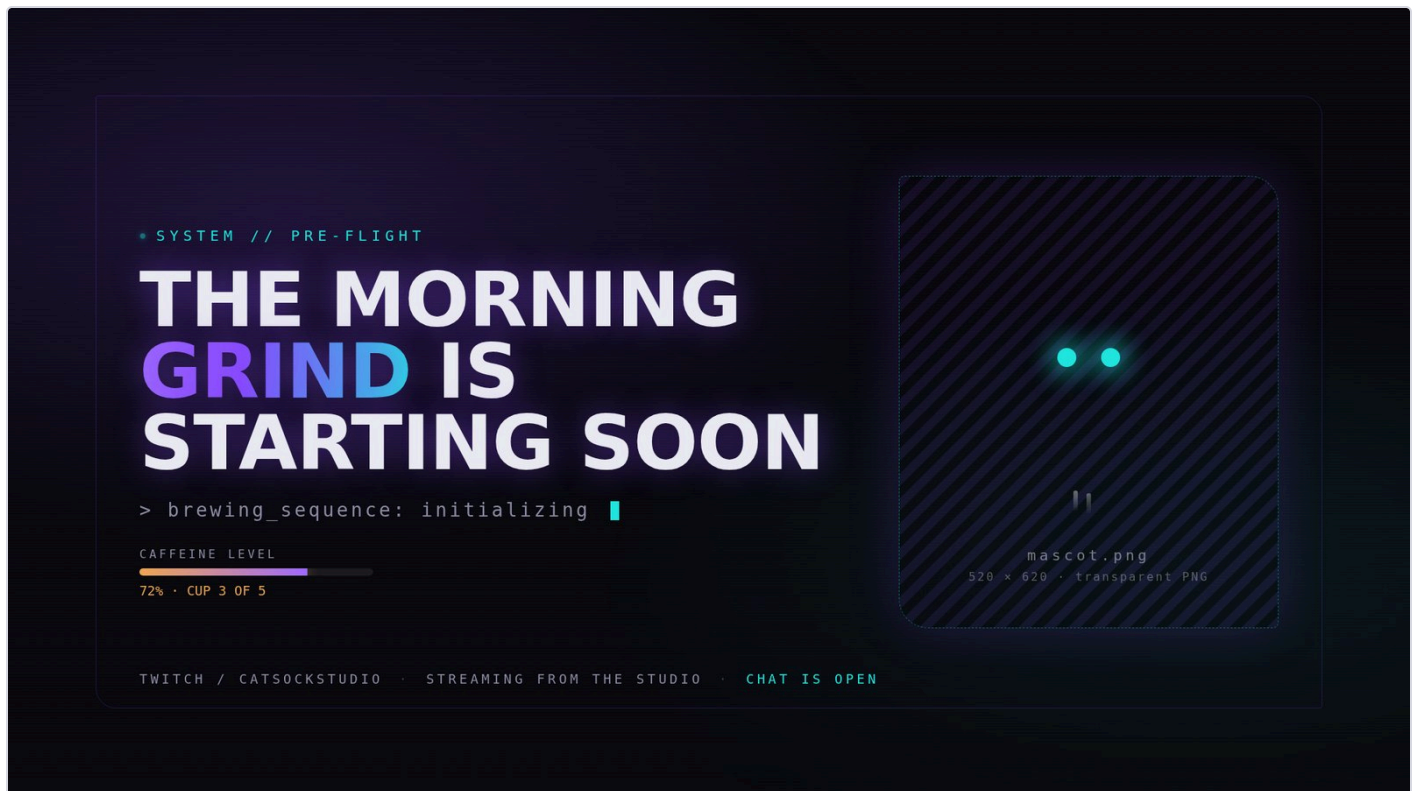
Below, each scene is shown over a stand-in background. Everything grey-blue behind the overlay is transparent in reality — your game or camera shows through it.



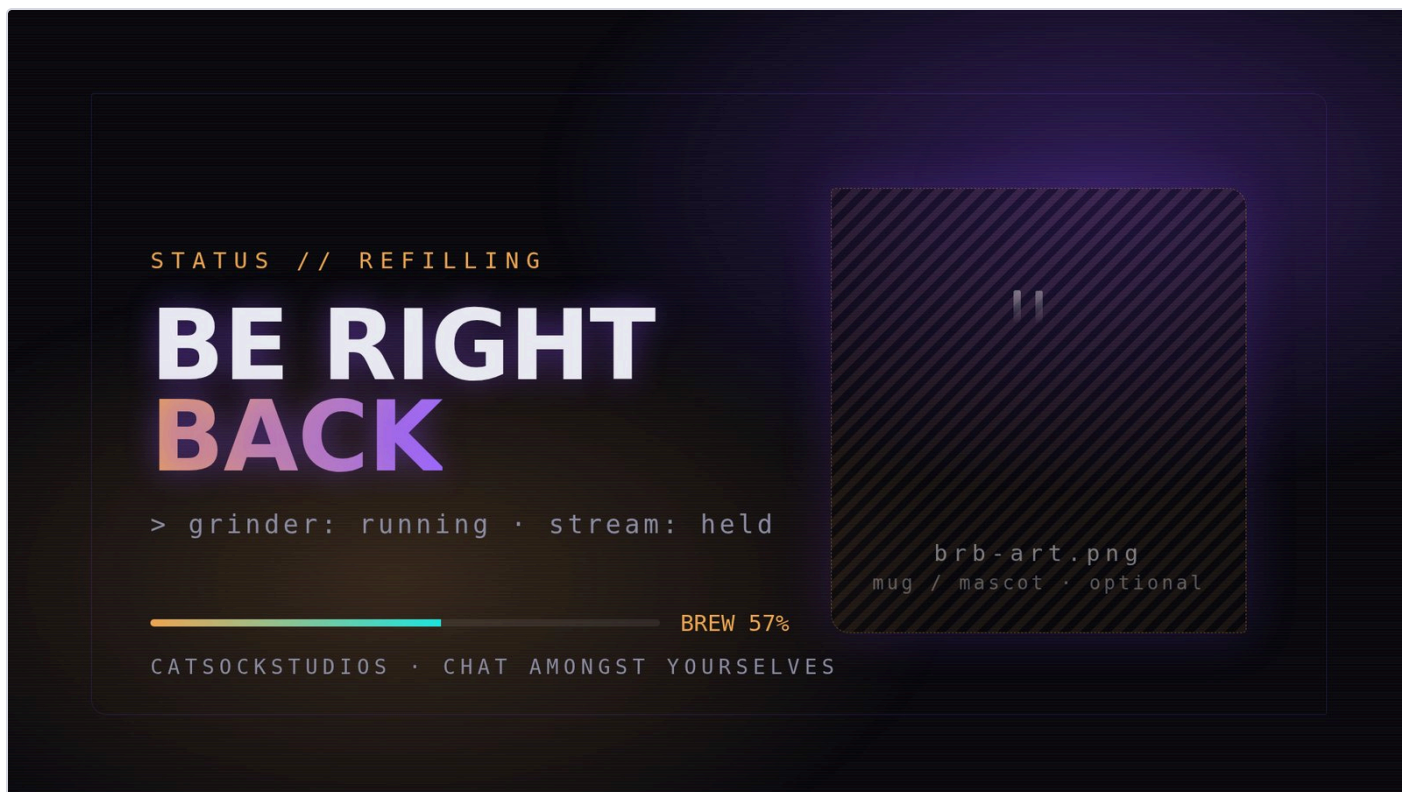
Gameplay — your main scene, and the only one with everything on it: brand bar, uptime strip, chat, camera frame, activity tiles and the goal rail. The empty middle is where your game capture goes; the bordered box at bottom-left is the camera cutout.



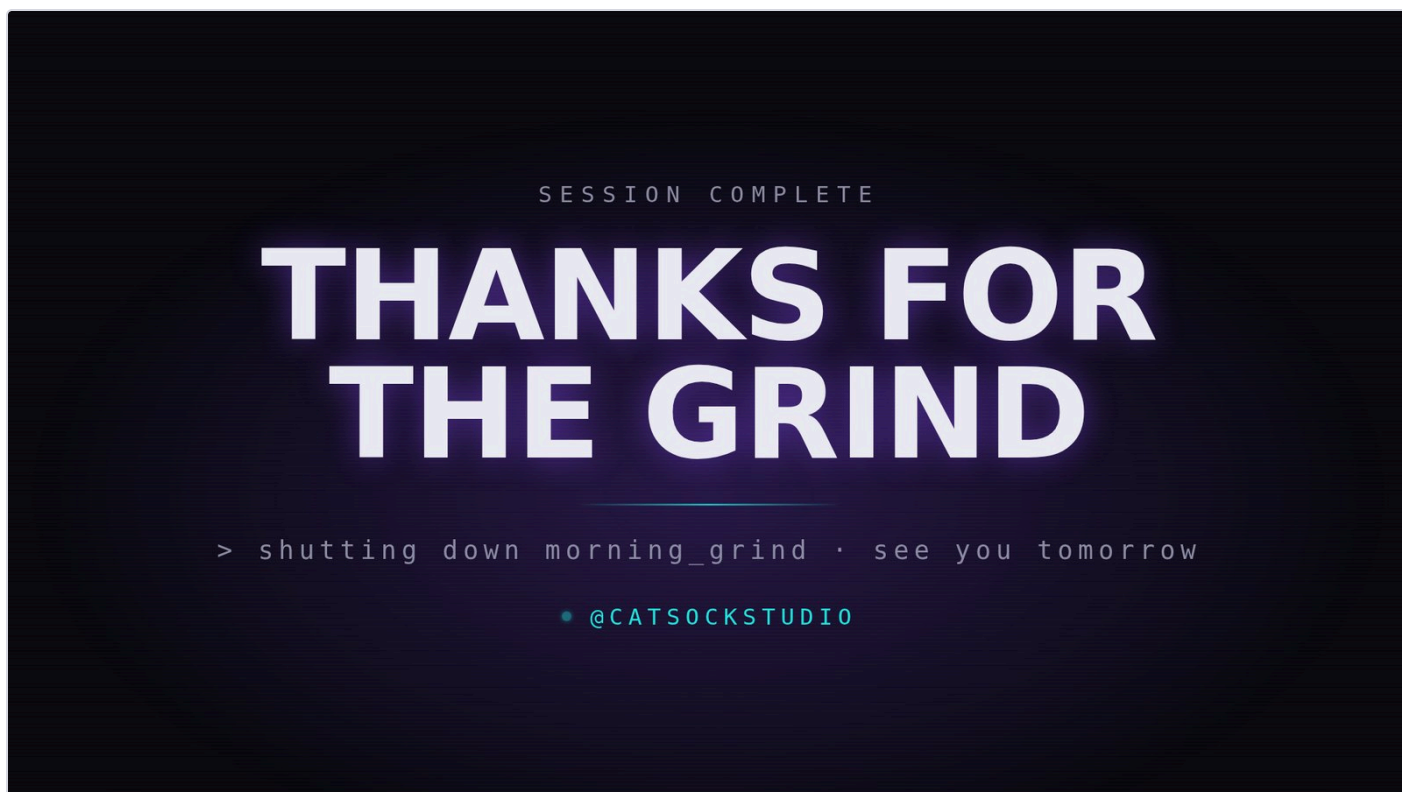
Just Chatting — a large camera opening with chat alongside and the goal rail beneath. Alerts appear on this scene and on Gameplay.



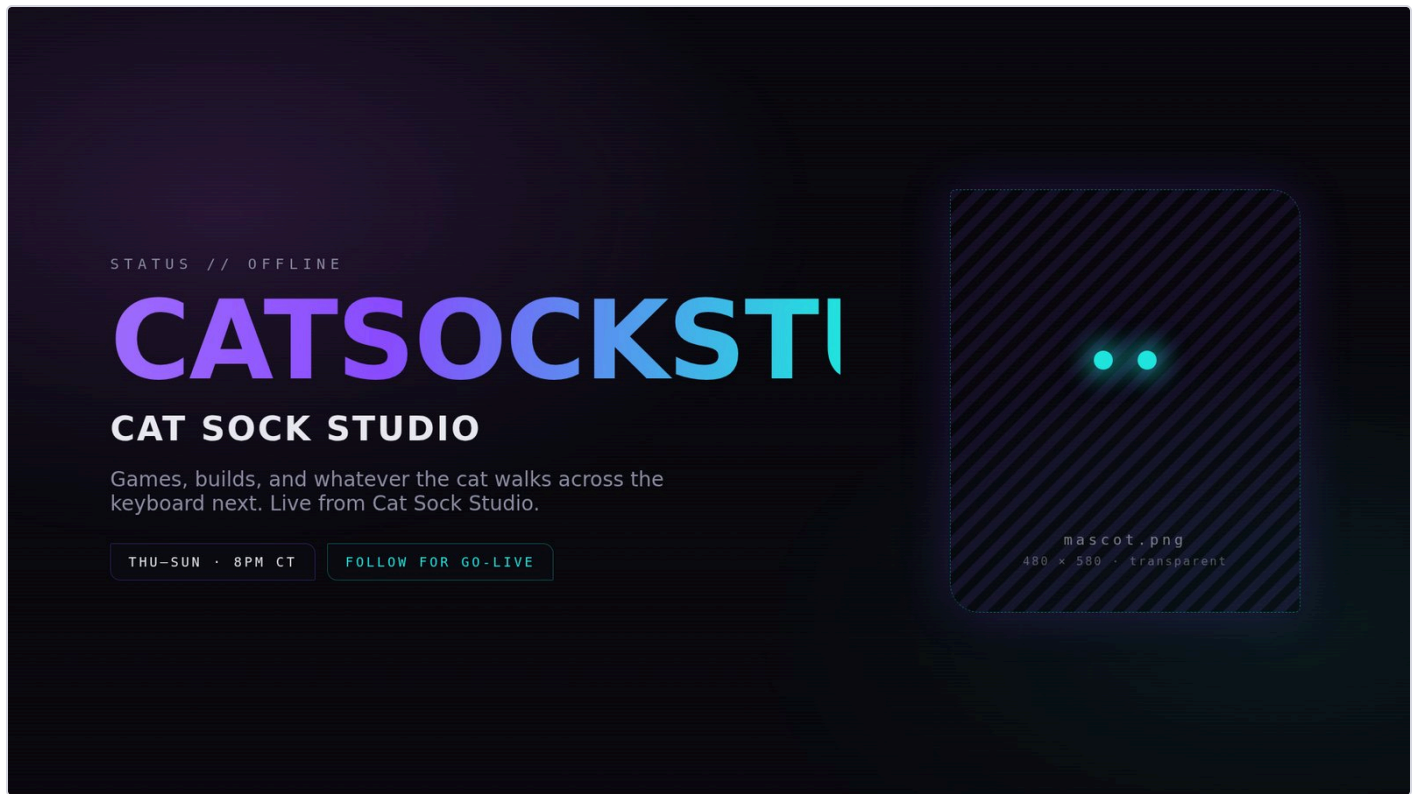
Starting Soon — a full-screen card for before you go live, with an optional countdown. Set the countdown minutes on the Live Control page.



BRB — for short breaks.



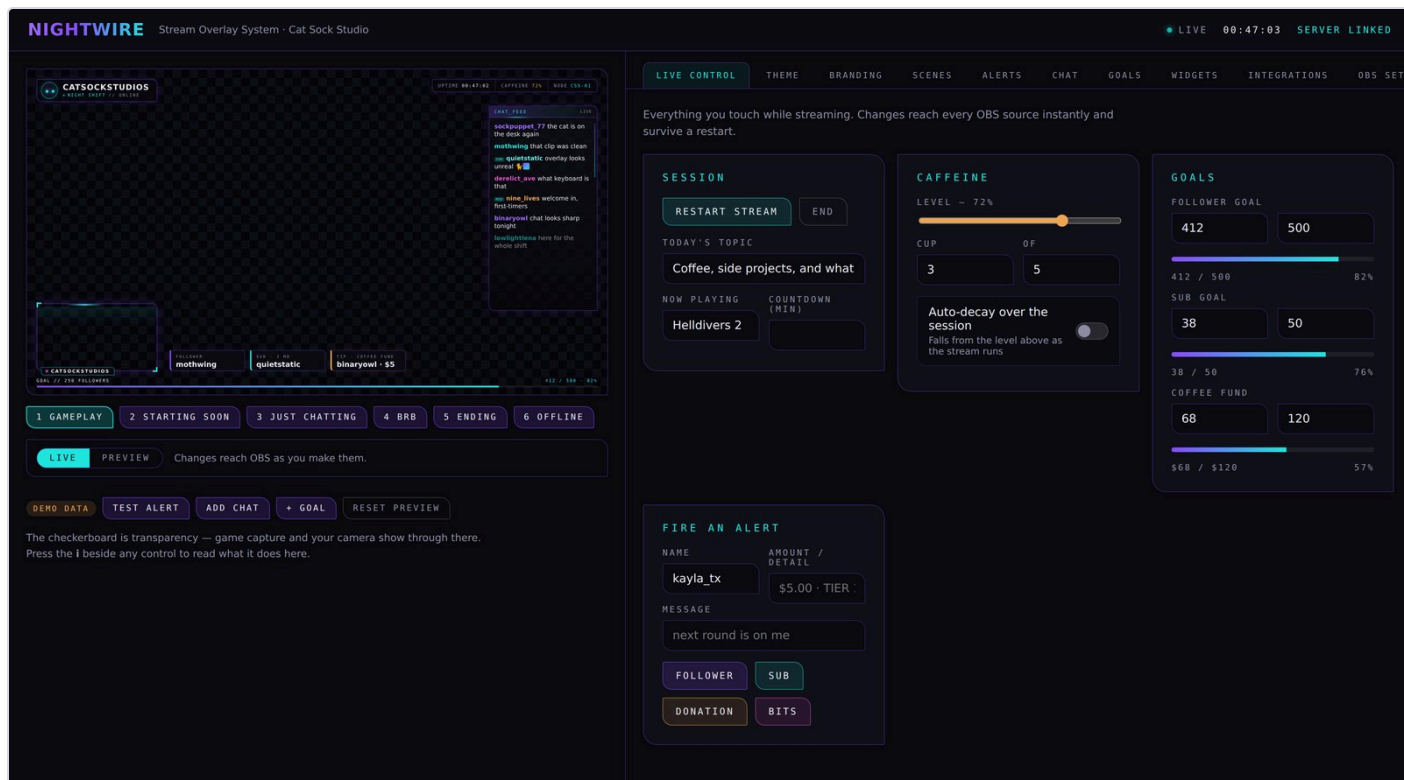
Ending — for the end of a stream.



Offline — a static card with your schedule and tagline, for when you are not streaming. All the wording on these four cards is editable on the **Scenes** page.

The dashboard

One page, two halves. The left half is what you are looking at. The right half is what you are changing. They work independently.



The dashboard with **Live Control** open.

Left – the preview

The numbered buttons under the preview choose **which scene you are looking at**. This is only a viewer; it does not change what OBS is showing. The chequerboard is transparency — that is where your game and camera show through.

The four buttons marked **DEMO DATA** put fake activity on screen so you can see your settings working: a test alert, a chat message, some progress on a goal.

The demo buttons reach your real overlay.

They are not sandboxed to the preview — a test alert plays on every open OBS source, including on stream. Use them while setting up, not while live.

Right – the pages

The tabs across the top choose **what you are editing**. Most settings are global: an alert looks the same on every scene, and a colour change applies everywhere. Only the **Scenes** page is tied to the scene selected on the left.

Every page puts the everyday controls first. Anything folded under **ADVANCED** is optional — you never have to open it.

Changes are instant and permanent.

There is no Save button. Every change reaches OBS the moment you make it, and is remembered after a restart.

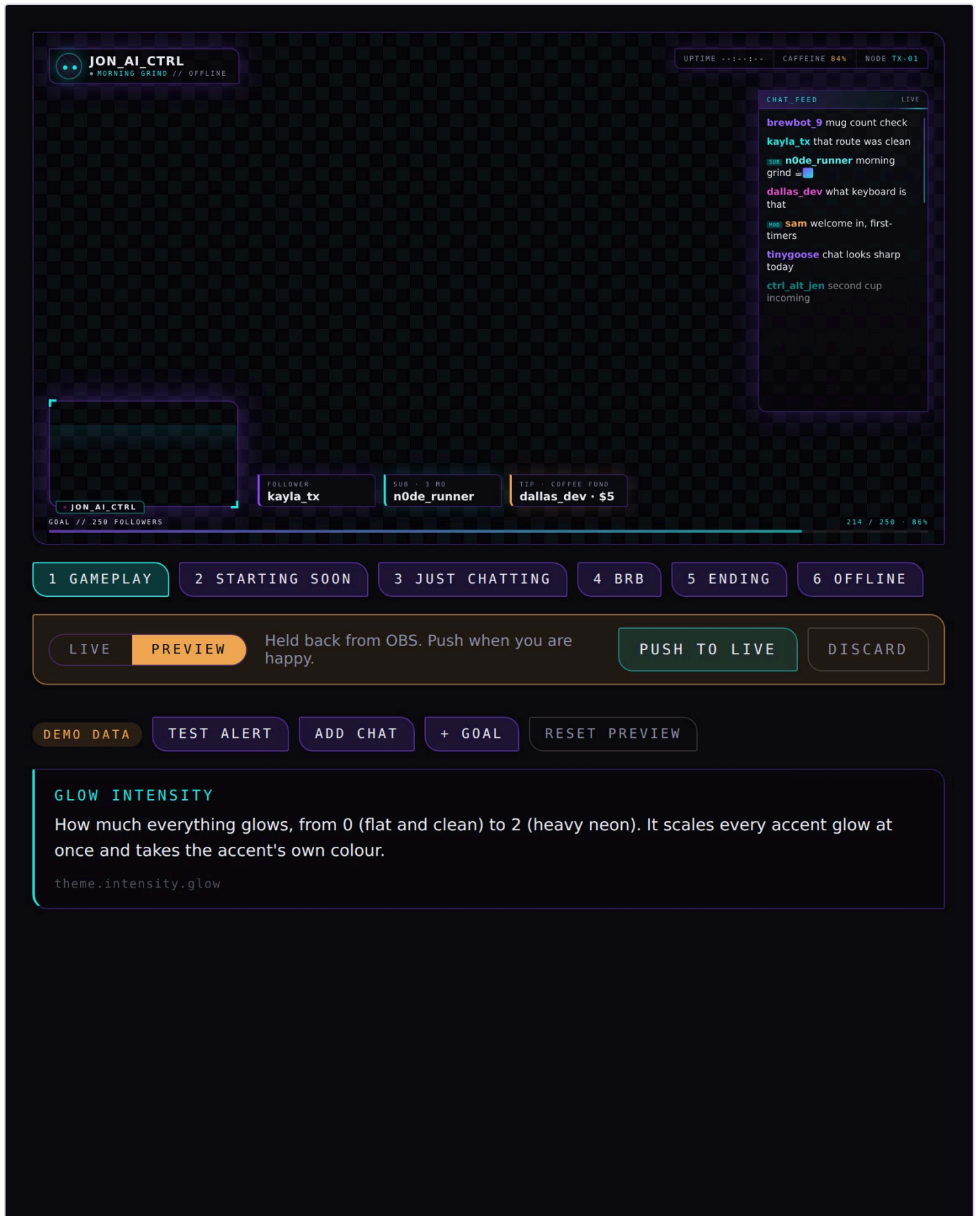
Two things that will save you time

Read this before you start changing settings. Both answer the same question: is this control broken, or am I looking in the wrong place?

The **i** button

Every control has a small **i** beside it. Press it and an explanation appears in the panel under the preview — what the control changes, and, where it matters, what it does **not**.

That second half is the important one. Most settings only show up in certain places. Chat position does nothing on the BRB card, because BRB has no chat. Background brightness does nothing on Gameplay, because Gameplay is transparent. Half the recent-events controls do nothing while Activity is set to TILES. None of that is broken — but you cannot tell by looking, so the **i** tells you.



The left column: preview, scene buttons, the Live/Preview switch, the demo buttons, and the explanation for whichever control you last pressed **i** on.

LIVE and PREVIEW

The switch under the scene buttons decides where your changes go.

MODE	WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU CHANGE SOMETHING
LIVE	It reaches OBS immediately. This is the normal setting.
PREVIEW	It shows in the preview only. OBS keeps showing what it showed before.

In PREVIEW, two buttons appear. **PUSH TO LIVE** sends everything you have changed to OBS in one go and returns you to LIVE. **DISCARD** throws it away.

This is how you redecorate mid-stream.

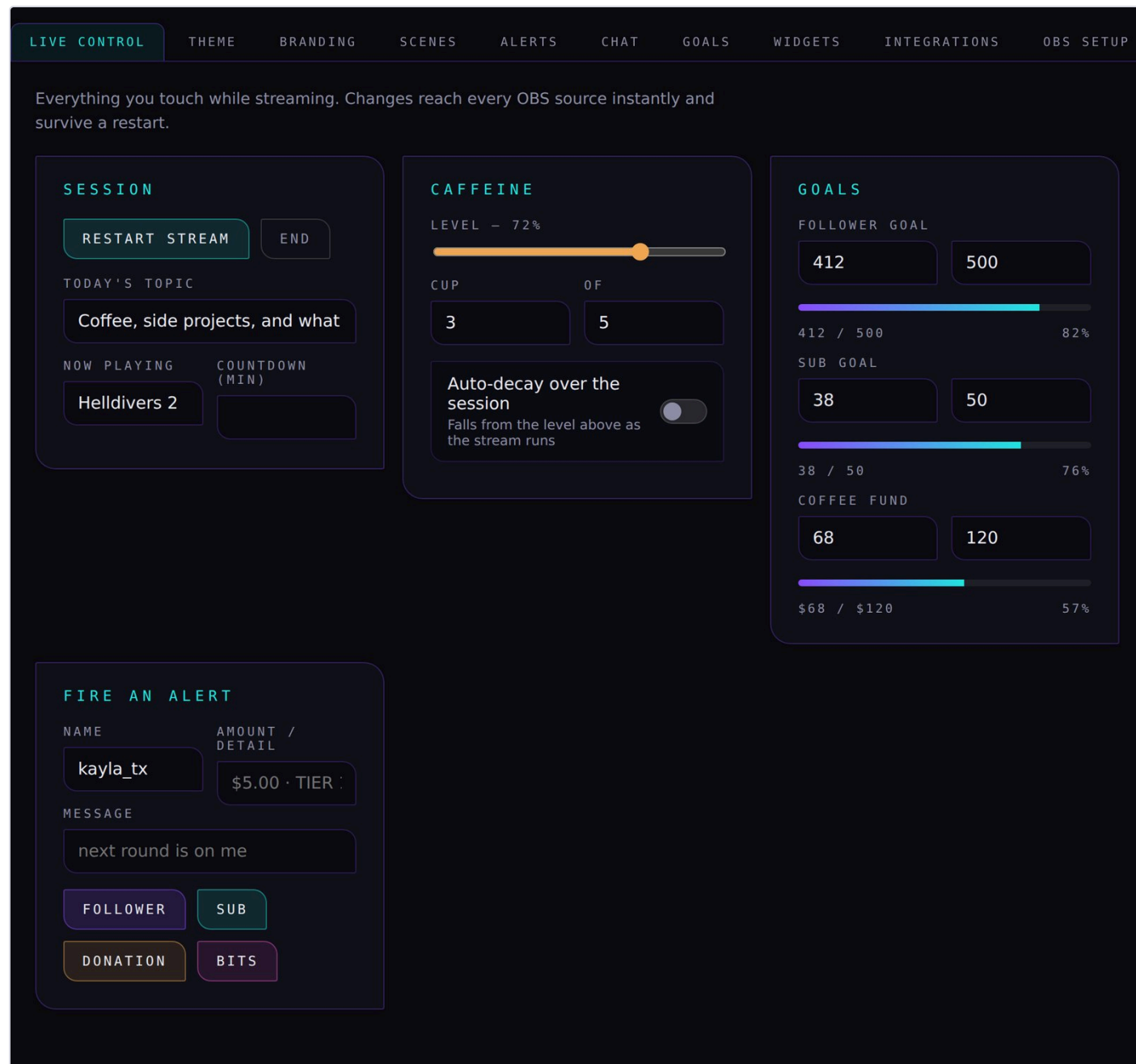
Switch to PREVIEW, change as much as you like, check it in the preview, then push when you are happy. Your audience sees one clean change instead of watching you try eleven colours.

The demo buttons follow the same rule.

In PREVIEW, *Test Alert* plays in the preview only — nobody watching sees a fake follower. In LIVE, it plays on your real overlay, so save it for before you go on.

Live Control

The page you keep open while streaming. Four cards.



Session, Caffeine, Goals and Fire an Alert.

Session

START STREAM tells the overlay you have gone live. It turns the status dot green, starts the uptime clock, and begins caffeine decay if you use it. It does not start your OBS stream — you still do that in OBS. Once you are live

the button reads **RESTART STREAM**; pressing it sets the clock back to zero. **END** returns you to offline.

Today's topic and **Now playing** appear on the overlay as you type. **Countdown** sets the timer on the Starting Soon card, in minutes. Leave it blank for no countdown.

Caffeine

A running joke that doubles as a stream-length indicator. Set the level and which cup you are on. **Auto-decay** makes it fall gradually as the stream runs, so you do not have to touch it.

Goals

Current and target for followers, subs and the coffee fund. The goal rail across the bottom of the Gameplay scene follows whichever goal you nominate on the Widgets page.

Fire an Alert

For when something actually happens and you want to acknowledge it by name. Type the name, and an amount or tier if it applies, then press the matching button. This also updates the activity tile for that type on the Gameplay scene.

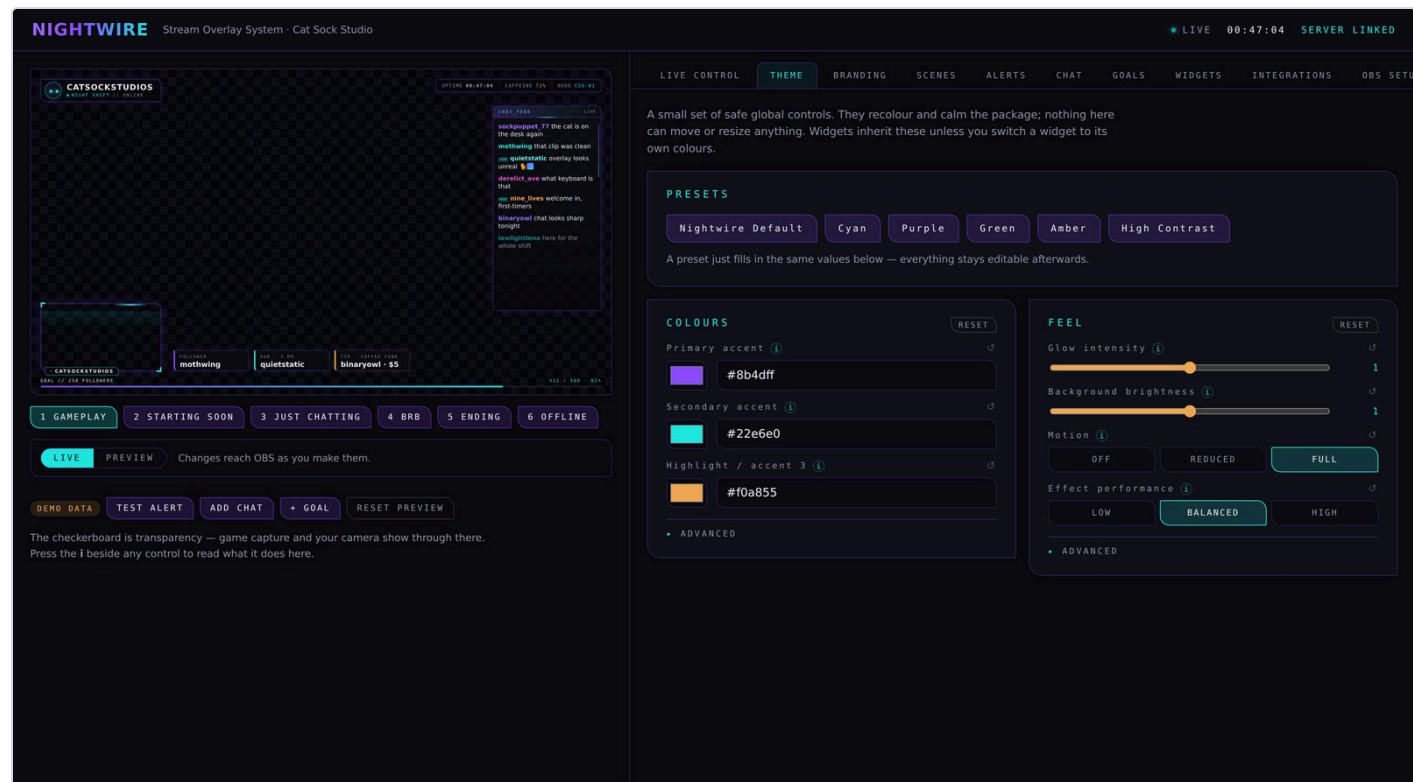
BUTTON	ALSO UPDATES
FOLLOWER	The follower tile
SUB	The sub tile
DONATION	The coffee-fund tile
BITS	Nothing — alert only

Fire an Alert vs Test Alert.

Fire an Alert uses the name you typed and updates the tiles. *Test Alert*, under the preview, uses made-up demo details and changes nothing else — it is for checking how an alert looks while you design it.

Theme

The look of the whole package, in one place.



Presets, colours and feel. Nothing here can break the layout.

Presets

Six one-click looks. A preset sets the colours and leaves everything else alone, so it is a starting point rather than a reset — change any colour afterwards and your change sticks.

Colours

Primary is the main accent, used for the brand bar, borders and most glows. **Secondary** is the contrast accent, used for live indicators and goal fills. **Highlight** is for money — tips and the coffee fund. Background and text colours are under ADVANCED and rarely need changing.

Feel

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Glow intensity	How much everything glows. 0 is flat and clean; 2 is heavy neon.
Background brightness	How dark the full-screen cards are.
Motion	Full is everything. Reduced stills most animation. Off stops all of it.
Effect performance	Caps how expensive the alert effects are allowed to be.

If OBS is working hard,

set

Effect performance

to

LOW

and

Motion

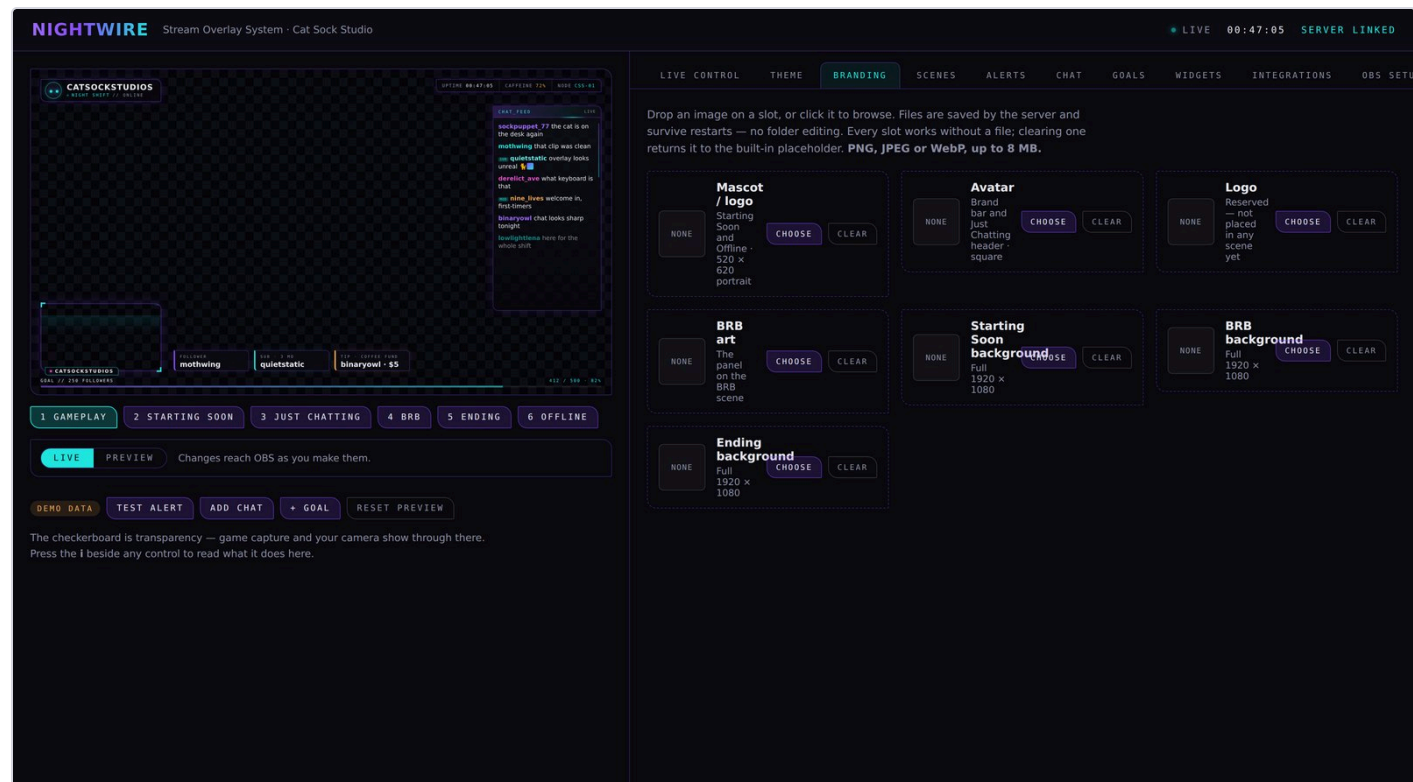
to

Reduced

. That switches off the costly effects while keeping the glow, so it still looks like your overlay rather than a broken one.

Branding

Your own artwork. Every slot is optional.



Drop an image on a slot, or click to browse.

The package is designed to look finished with **no artwork at all** — every slot has a built-in placeholder drawn in code. Adding your own is an upgrade, never a requirement.

Drop a file on a slot or click it to browse. It is copied into the package and remembered. **Clear** puts the built-in placeholder back.

SLOT	WHERE IT APPEARS	SUGGESTED SIZE
Mascot / logo	Starting Soon and Offline	520 × 620 portrait
Avatar	Brand bar, and the Just Chatting header	Square, 256 × 256
BRB art	The panel on the BRB card	570 × 610 portrait
Starting Soon background	Behind the Starting Soon card	1920 × 1080
BRB background	Behind the BRB card	1920 × 1080
Ending background	Behind the Ending card	1920 × 1080
Offline background	Behind the Offline card	1920 × 1080

PNG, JPEG or WebP, up to 8 MB. PNG with transparency is best for logos.

Artwork appears straight away.

You do not need to restart the server, reload a browser source, or touch OBS at all — drop the file on a slot and the scenes already open in OBS pick it up within a second.

Clear

takes it back off the same way.

Your uploads are safe from resets.

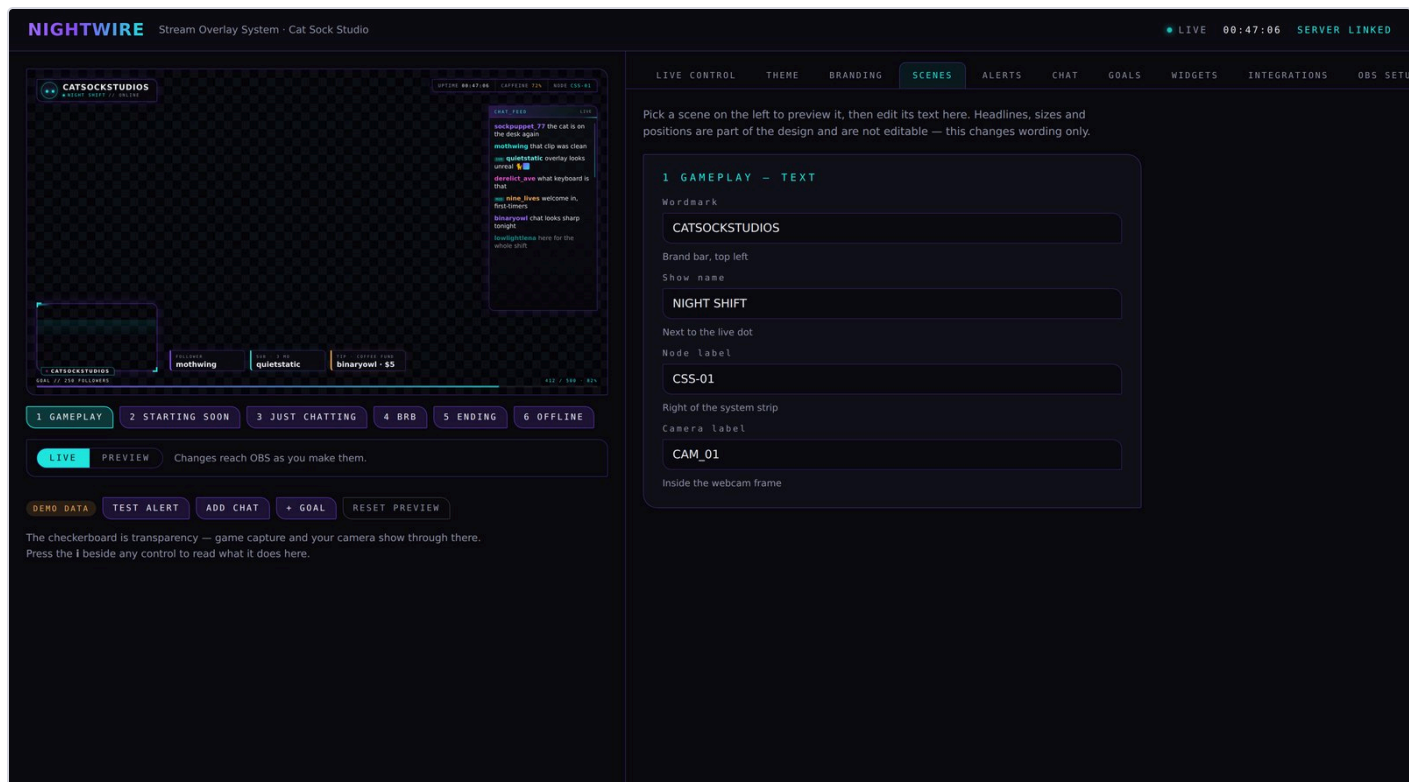
No reset button removes artwork — not even *Reset everything*. Only the

Clear

button on the slot itself deletes a file.

Scenes

The wording on the full-screen cards.



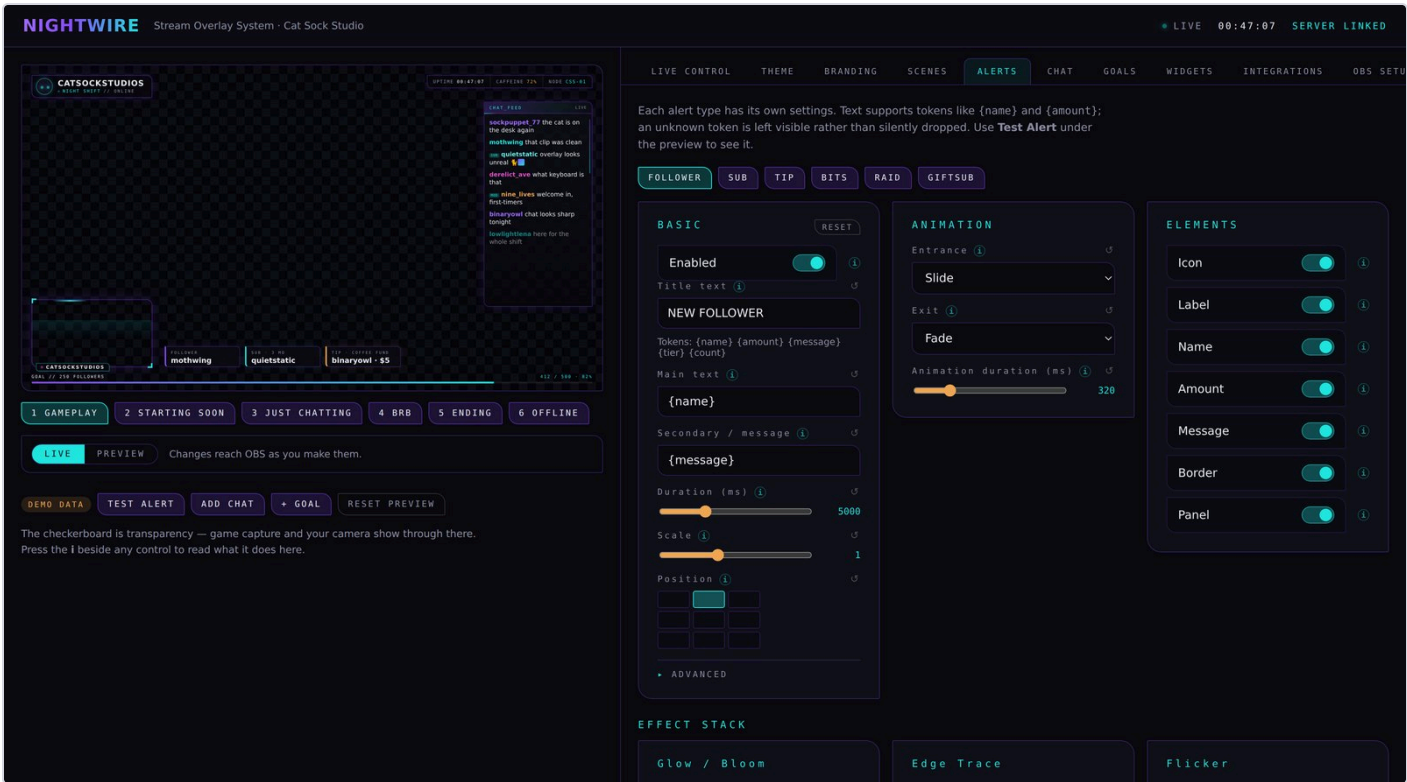
Choose a scene on the left, edit its text here.

This is the one page tied to the scene selected in the preview. Pick a scene on the left, and the fields here change to that scene's wording — headline, sub-line, schedule, tagline.

Sizes and positions are part of the design and are not editable. That is deliberate: it is what stops the package from being broken by accident. Long text shrinks to fit rather than overflowing.

Alerts

Six types, each with its own wording, timing, position and effects.



Pick a type along the top; everything below applies to that type only.

Wording

Alert text uses tags that get filled in when the alert fires:

TAG	BECOMES
{name}	The person's name
{amount}	The tip amount or bit count
{message}	Their message, if any
{tier}	Sub tier
{count}	Raid viewers, or number of gift subs

So a title of `COFFEE FUND · {amount}` becomes *COFFEE FUND · \$5.00*. A tag you mistype is left on screen as written rather than vanishing, so you can see the error.

Timing, size and position

Duration is how long the alert stays up. **Scale** makes it bigger or smaller — the package will not let you scale it off the edge of the screen. **Position** is a nine-square grid; placement is preset-only, which is what guarantees nothing ends up half off-screen.

Elements

Switch off any part you do not want: the icon, the label, the name, the amount, the message, the border, or the whole panel behind it. Turning the panel off gives you floating text with no box.

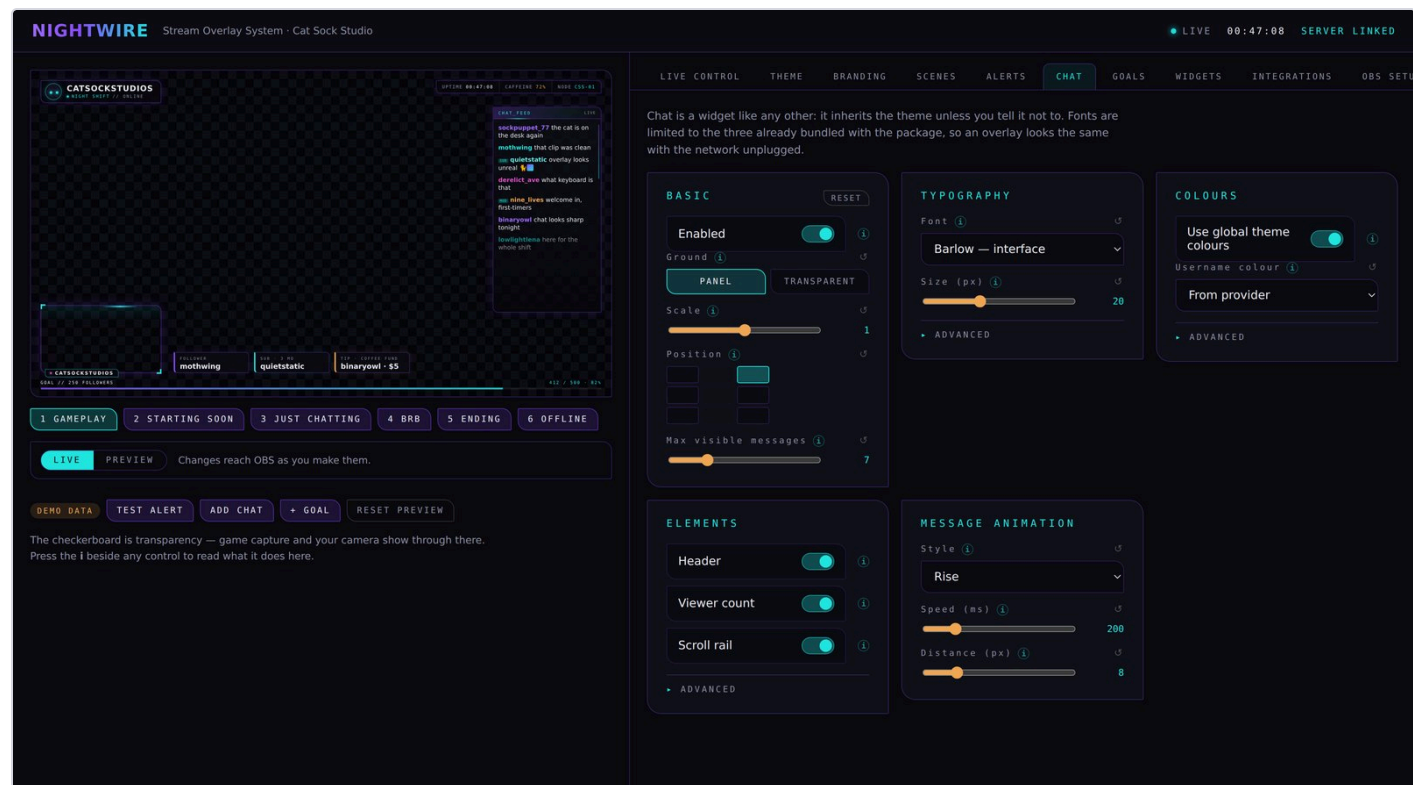
Effect stack

Nine effects you can stack. Each has its own settings.

EFFECT	COST
Glow / Bloom	Low — always on, whatever the performance setting
Edge Trace, Flicker, Scanlines	Low
RGB Split, Ghosting, VHS Slice	Medium — needs BALANCED or HIGH
CRT Distortion, Noise	High — needs HIGH

If you switch on an effect your performance setting does not allow, the page tells you why it is not running rather than silently ignoring it.

Chat



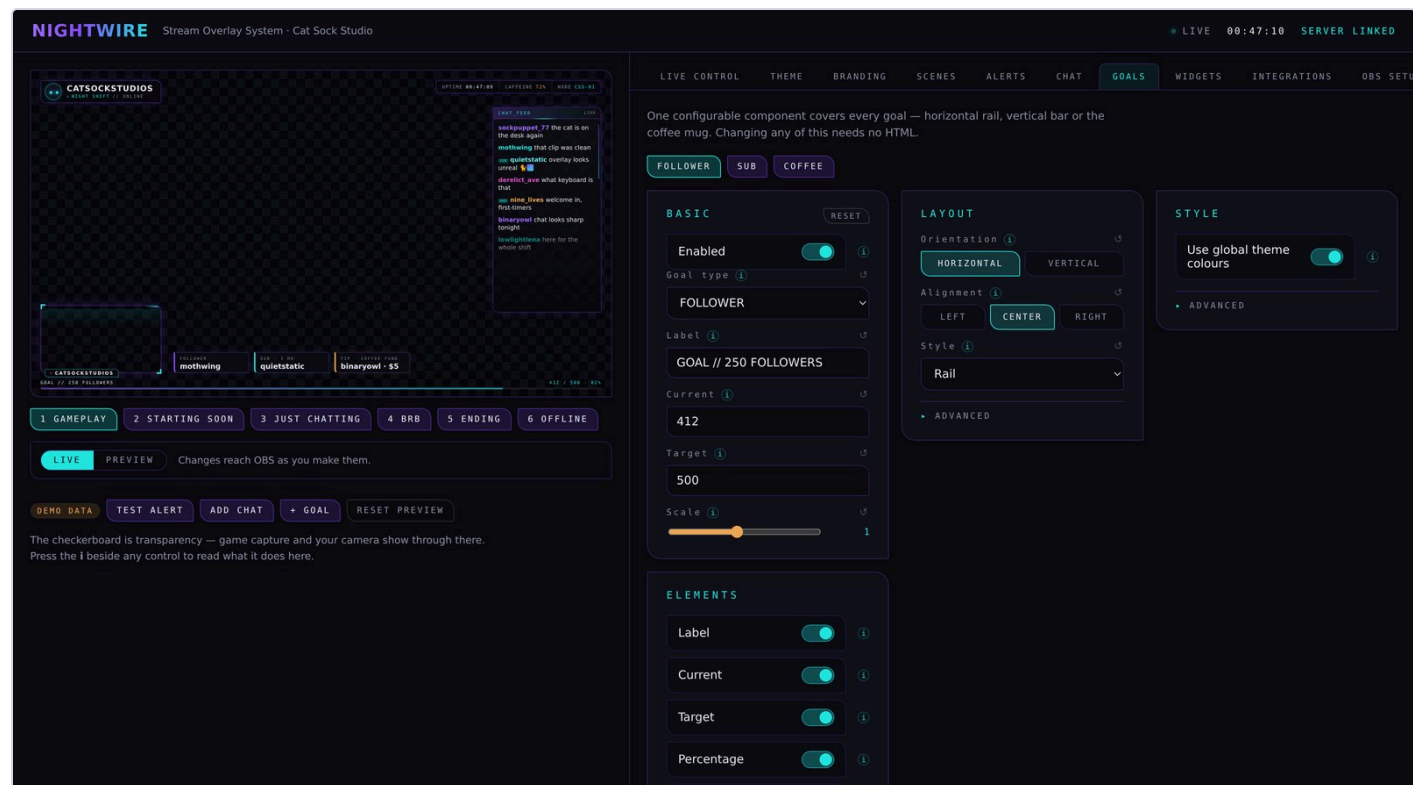
Typography, colours, and which parts of a message show.

Newest messages are at the top; older ones fade out beneath. Set the font, size and weight, how many messages show at once, and whether badges and timestamps appear.

Ground decides what sits behind the messages — a panel, individual bubbles, or nothing at all for text straight over your game.

Username colour offers a different colour per person, one accent for everyone, or plain theme text.

Goals



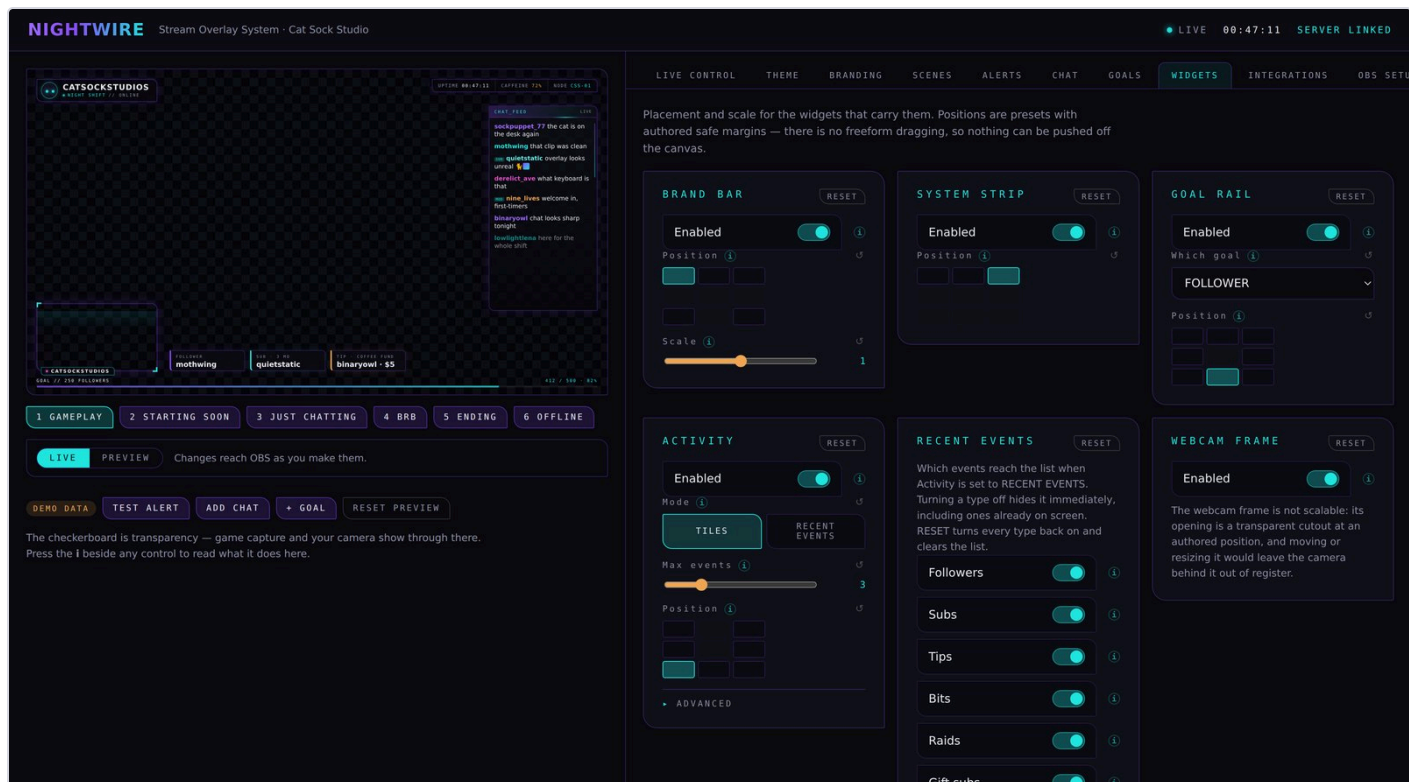
Three goals, each independently styled.

Each goal can run **across** or **upright**, and can be drawn as a thin rail, as segments, or as the coffee mug. Turn off any part — label, value, target, percentage, icon.

Numbers themselves live on **Live Control**, so you are not digging through the customiser mid-stream to update a follower count.

Widgets

Where each piece sits, and how big it is.



On/off, position and scale for every widget.

Each widget can be switched off, moved to one of nine preset positions, and scaled within a safe range. There is no free dragging — presets keep safe margins so nothing ends up under a Twitch overlay or off the edge.

The camera frame cannot be moved or scaled.

Its opening is a transparent cutout at an exact position. Moving it would leave your camera out of register behind it, so the control is deliberately not offered.

Recent events

Set **Activity** → **Mode** to **Recent events** and the three tiles become a running list of who just followed, subbed, tipped, cheered or raided. Choose how many show and which kinds count.

The list covers the current session only — it is never written to disk, so restarting starts it fresh rather than replaying yesterday.

OBS Setup page

NIGHTWIRE Stream Overlay System · Cat Sock Studio

LIVE 00:47:12 SERVER LINKED

LIVE CONTROL THEME BRANDING SCENES ALERTS CHAT GOALS WIDGETS INTEGRATIONS **OBS SETUP**

Add each of these in OBS as **Sources** → + → **Browser**, using the exact width and height. Scenes are all 1920 × 1080. Copy a URL with the button on its right.

SCENES - ONE BROWSER SOURCE EACH

Scene	URL	Size	Action
Gameplay	http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/gameplay.html	1920 × 1080	COPY
Starting Soon	http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/starting-soon.html	1920 × 1080	COPY
Just Chatting	http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/just-chatting.html	1920 × 1080	COPY
BRB	http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/brb.html	1920 × 1080	COPY
Ending	http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/ending.html	1920 × 1080	COPY
Offline	http://127.0.0.1:8787/scenes/offLine.html	1920 × 1080	COPY

MODULES - ONLY IF PLACING PIECES SEPARATELY

Module	URL	Size	Action
Brand bar	http://127.0.0.1:8787/modules/brand-bar.html	344 × 76	COPY
System strip	http://127.0.0.1:8787/modules/system-strip.html	420 × 44	COPY
Chat	http://127.0.0.1:8787/modules/chat.html	360 × 680	COPY
Webcam frame	http://127.0.0.1:8787/modules/webcam-frame.html	480 × 253	COPY

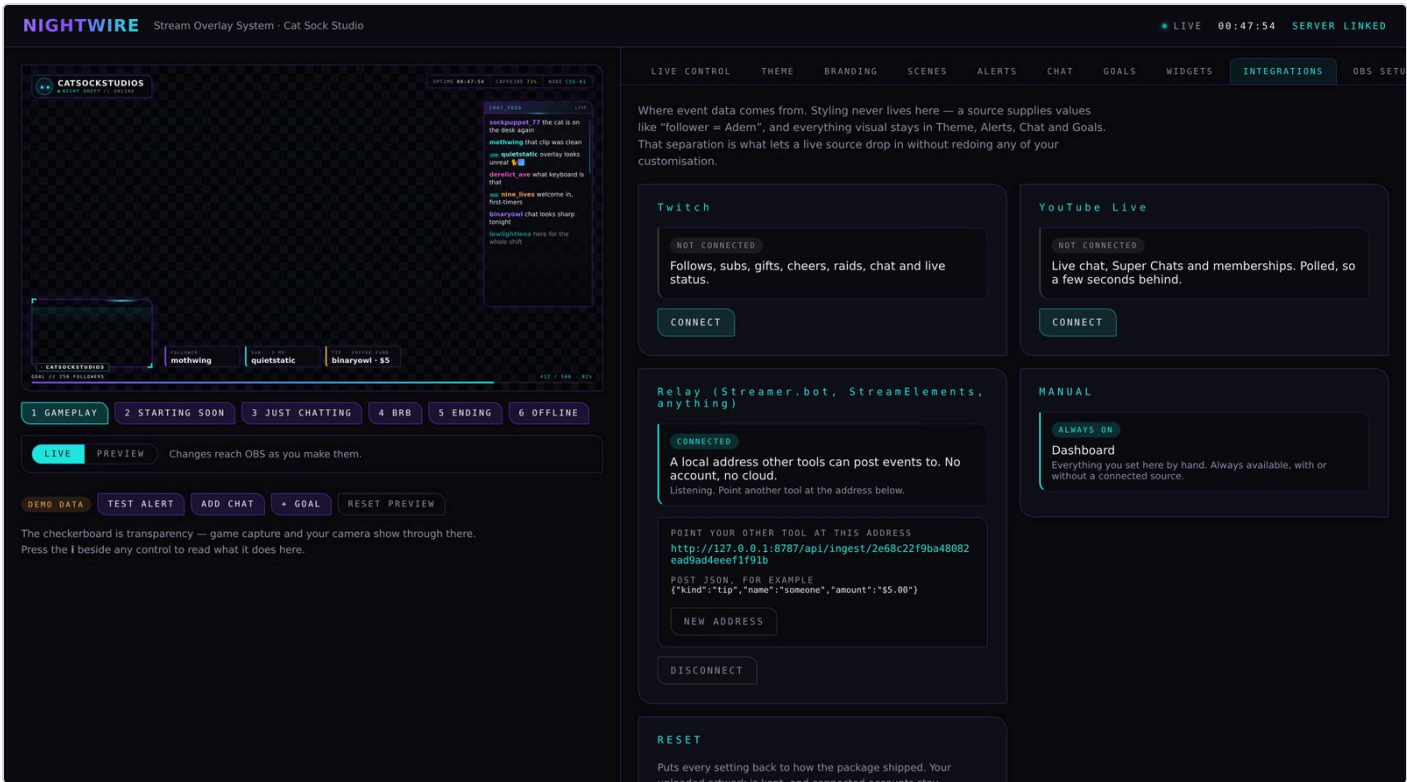
Every address, with a copy button, and the size each source needs.

Keep this page open while you build scenes by hand. It lists every scene and every individual widget, with the exact width and height to give each browser source.

The individual widget addresses are there if you want to build your own layout rather than use the full-scene overlays — for example, chat on its own in a corner of a scene you designed yourself.

Connecting Twitch or YouTube

Optional. Everything works by hand without this — connecting just means you stop typing names in.



The **Integrations** page. Manual control keeps working alongside anything you connect.

What each one gives you

SOURCE	SUPPLIES
Twitch	Follows, subs, resubs, gift subs, cheers, raids, chat, and live status
YouTube Live	Live chat, Super Chats, memberships, and live status
Relay	Anything else that can send a message — see below
Manual	Everything, by hand. Never switched off.

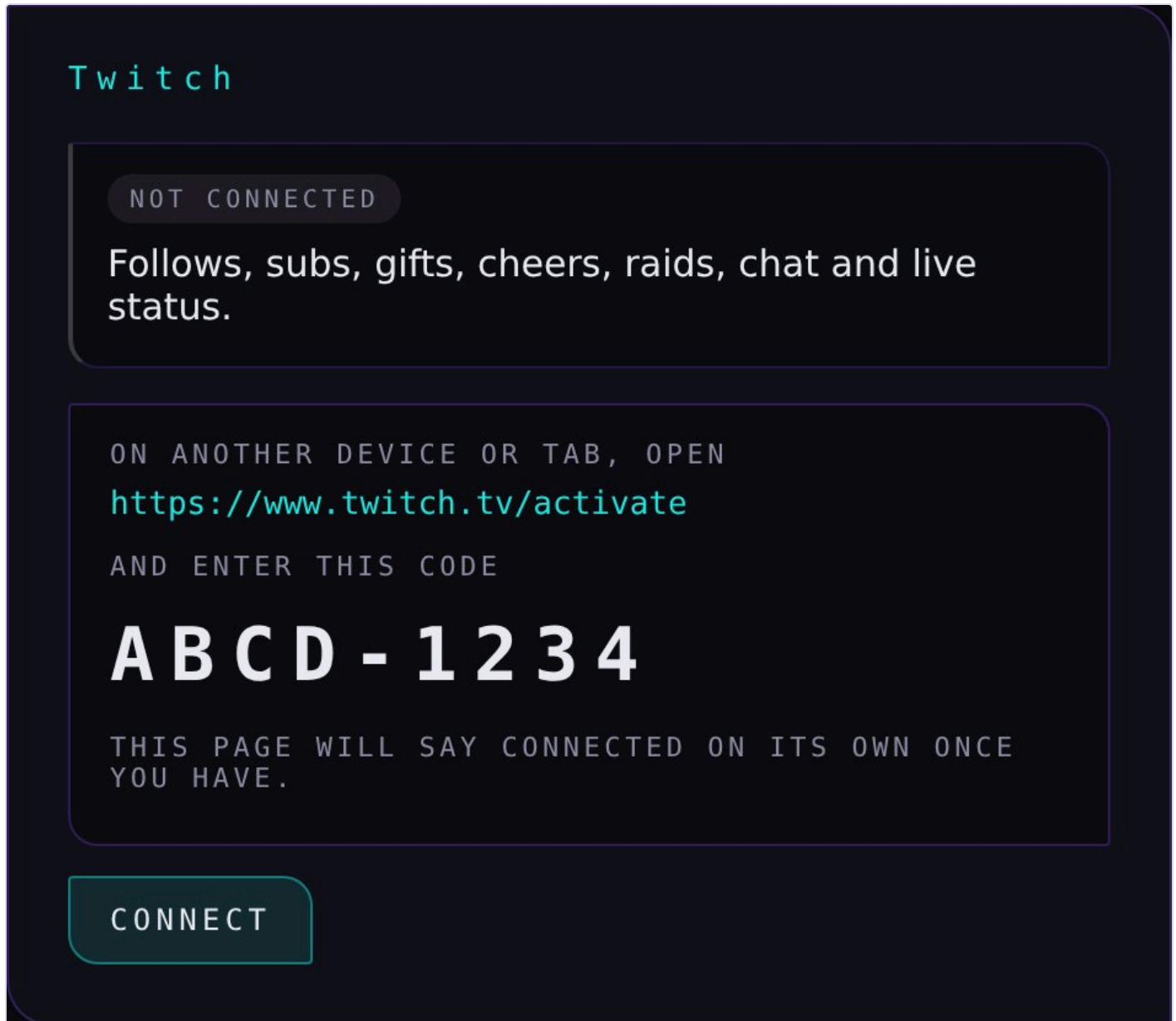
Connecting

- 1 Press **CONNECT** on the source you want.
- 2 A short code appears.
Open the address shown — for Twitch that is `twitch.tv/activate` — and type the code in.

3

That is it.

The page changes to CONNECTED by itself. You do not need to come back and press anything.



What you see between pressing Connect and approving it.

You are never asked for your password.

You type a short code on the platform's own website, and it hands back permission. This package never sees your Twitch or Google password, and the permissions it asks for are read-only — it cannot post, ban, or change anything on your channel.

What changes once you are connected

Alerts fire on their own. Chat fills in by itself. The uptime clock starts when you go live and stops when you end, so you no longer press START STREAM.

Some fields on **Live Control** grey out — your follower count, for example. That is deliberate: while Twitch is reporting a number, letting you type over it would be a lie, because the next event would overwrite whatever you typed. Disconnect and they become editable again.

YouTube has no follower alert.

YouTube does not publish subscriptions live, so there is nothing to listen for. Super Chats, memberships and chat all work. This is a YouTube limitation, not a missing feature.

The Relay – everything else

The relay is a local address that any other tool can send events to: Streamer.bot, StreamElements, Streamlabs, a Kick bridge, a Stream Deck button, or a script you wrote. If it can send a web request, it can drive your overlay.

The address is on the Integrations page, ready to copy. Anything sent to it appears exactly as if it came from Twitch. **NEW ADDRESS** changes the key, which stops any tool you set up earlier until you paste the new one in.

Signing out

DISCONNECT forgets the account. Note that *Reset everything* does **not** sign you out — settings and accounts are kept separately on purpose.

Undoing changes

Three levels, smallest first. You cannot get permanently lost.

CONTROL

UNDONES

The small  beside a setting

That one setting

RESET on a card

Everything on that card

Reset everything on Integrations

All settings — but never your uploaded artwork

Your artwork is never removed by a reset.

Only the

Clear

button on an individual Branding slot deletes a file.

If a reset button seems to do nothing

The dashboard will tell you. If the overlay server is running an older version than the files on disk — which happens after an update, because the server keeps running from when you signed in — a yellow banner appears across the top of the dashboard telling you to restart it. Run `Stop Server.bat`, then `Start Server.bat`.

Going live – checklist

- 1 Check the dashboard says SERVER LINKED.**
Top right. If it says unreachable, run `Start Server.bat`.
- 2 Check the switch says LIVE, not PREVIEW.**
In PREVIEW your changes are held back from OBS on purpose. Push them, or switch back.
- 3 Turn off the setup aids.**
On the Widgets page, switch off *Sample gameplay plate* and *Safe-area guides* if you used them for positioning.
- 4 Set today's topic and what you are playing.**
Live Control, top card.
- 5 Update your goal numbers.**
Live Control, Goals card.
- 6 Start your stream in OBS.**
- 7 Press START STREAM on the dashboard.**
This starts the uptime clock and turns the status dot green.
Skip this if you have connected Twitch or YouTube
— they tell the overlay you are live on their own.

Do not press the DEMO DATA buttons once you are live.

Test Alert, Add Chat and + Goal all reach your real overlay, and your viewers will see them.

When you finish

Press **END** on Live Control to go back to offline, and switch OBS to the Offline scene. Leave the server running — it costs nothing and will be ready next time.

If something looks wrong

The overlay is blank in OBS

Right-click the browser source and choose **Refresh**. If it is still blank, check the server is running with `Server Status.bat`. A source that fails will normally display the reason on screen rather than going blank, so read what it says.

My camera is covered by the overlay

The camera source is above the overlay in the source list. Drag it below. The overlay has a transparent hole cut for it and is meant to sit on top.

My camera is covered by my game capture

On the Gameplay scene, game capture is a full-screen, opaque source. If it is listed above the camera, it hides the camera wherever the two overlap. Drag the camera above the game capture — the source list should read Overlay, then Camera, then Game Capture, top to bottom.

The dashboard says **SERVER UNREACHABLE**

Run `Start Server.bat`. If it says the port is already in use, a server is already running — refresh the dashboard instead. If you have just installed an update, see the next entry first: the server holding the port may be the old one.

I installed an update and nothing changed

Almost always this: a server from the **previous** copy of the package is still running. It holds the port, so `Start Server.bat` in the new folder exits with “port already in use”, and every page carries on being served the old code. Nothing on screen looks wrong — the dashboard still works, uploads still save — the new behaviour simply is not there.

Check which copy is answering: the **OBS Setup** page shows the folder the running server is serving from, under **Which copy is running**. If that is not the folder you just extracted into, run `Stop Server.bat` (in either folder), then `Start Server.bat` from the new one, and refresh your OBS sources.

A button does nothing

Look for a yellow banner at the top of the dashboard. It means the running server is older than the files on disk, and it will tell you to restart. Run `Stop Server.bat` then `Start Server.bat`.

Text is overflowing or the font looks wrong

The package uses three web fonts and falls back to system fonts if it cannot reach the internet. Headlines shrink to fit rather than overflowing, so it will still be readable — it will just look slightly different until you are back online.

Alerts are stuttering

Theme page: set **Effect performance** to **LOW** and **Motion** to **Reduced**. If it persists, your OBS canvas may be running at a higher resolution than your PC can encode comfortably — that is an OBS setting, not an overlay one.

A control seems to do nothing

Press the **i** beside it. Most settings only apply in certain places, and the explanation says where — chat settings do nothing on a card with no chat, background brightness does nothing on the transparent scenes, and the recent-events controls do nothing while Activity is set to **TILES**.

Then check the switch above the demo buttons. If it says **PREVIEW**, your changes are being held back on purpose and only the preview is showing them. Press **PUSH TO LIVE**, or switch back to **LIVE**.

I connected Twitch but nothing happens

Check the Integrations page says **CONNECTED** rather than **WAITING** — if it still says waiting, the code was never entered, so press **Connect** and try again. If it says **PROBLEM**, the message underneath names the cause. A source can also be connected but missing one kind of event, which it will say in the same place; that means a permission was not granted, and disconnecting and reconnecting fixes it.

Starting over

Integrations page, **Reset everything**. Your uploaded artwork survives. If the package itself seems damaged, re-run `Setup.bat`.